

TWO HUNDRED YEARS · FORT BROOKE TO WATER STREET

Downtown Tampa

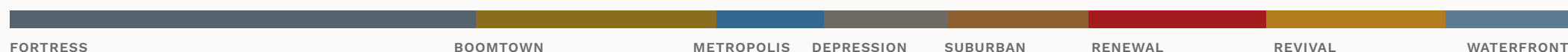
A Civic Development Autopsy

An open-data scrollytelling history of how a fort at a river mouth became a cigar capital, then a cleared grid, then a \$3 billion waterfront. Every figure cited. Every photograph rights-cleared.

BUILT OVER ONE WEEKEND · 29 COMMITS, SATURDAY NIGHT TO SUNDAY AFTERNOON

1824 FORT BROOKE

WATER STREET 2024



WHY BUILD THIS

Most civic history is a plaque you walk past.

This one has 257 footnotes.

A city's development story usually arrives as a marker on a sidewalk or a paragraph in a strategic plan — a claim with nothing behind it you can check. This is the same story told the way a dataset is told: **every number carries the institution, the date and the URL it came from**, and says out loud how confident it is.

Scroll a map through eight eras. Drag a slider across two centuries. Read the citation behind any figure that surprises you — and disagree with it, precisely.

26

MAPPED EVENTS,
EACH WITH A SOURCE

15

NARRATIVE STEPS
OVER A STICKY MAP

42

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPHS,
RIGHTS-CLEARED & CREDITED

THE PART I ACTUALLY CARE ABOUT

Every figure declares how much to trust it.

Data projects fail quietly: a confident number, no provenance, and no way to tell a census table from a guess. So every source object here carries a verification status, and the site prints the running count of each.

168**CONFIRMED**

The cited page states the figure. Hero and footer numbers are this tier only.

42**PENDING**

The institution is right; the figure was not read there. Still visible, still flagged.

47**DERIVED**

An editorial reconstruction. Its note names every input it was built from.

A COMPARISON, AND THE FIGURE THAT COMPLICATES IT

Public money cleared it. Public money is helping rebuild it.

1957 – 1974 • FEDERAL

\$36.8M

In urban renewal grants approved for Tampa. **\$28.2M** of it was actually disbursed.

HUD URBAN RENEWAL DIRECTORY, JUNE 1974
VIA U. OF RICHMOND DSL

2019 • PRIVATE

\$3B

Announced private investment in Water Street Tampa — against **up to \$100M** in CRA infrastructure reimbursement pledged by the city and county.

STRATEGIC PROPERTY PARTNERS, 9 JULY 2019
PUBLIC SHARE: \$50M CITY + \$50M COUNTY

The tidy version of this story is that public money cleared the ground and private money rebuilt it. The site's own data will not support that: both sides of the ledger have public money in them. Nominal dollars, no averaging, no conversion — and the caveat printed next to the number it qualifies.

STATIC SITE · NO BUILD STEP · NO BACKEND

Three files do all of it.

index.html, **js/data.js** and **js/app.js**. Open the folder, run a static server, and it works. Swap the data layer and it is a different city.

- 01** A scrollytelling Leaflet map that moves through eight named eras
- 02** A 1824–2024 year slider with six live metrics
- 03** Charts for population, port, cigars, capital and land use
- 04** Hand-built SVG sankeys: the 1925 economy against 2023
- 05** A nine-district impact matrix of wins, losses and rebuilds
- 06** 42 rights-cleared archival photographs, 1837–2024
- 07** A live source audit — every institution and its status
- 08** A link checker that requests all 257 source URLs

29COMMITTS, SATURDAY NIGHT
TO SUNDAY AFTERNOON**0**NPM DEPENDENCIES
IN THE SITE ITSELF**CC0**CODE LICENCE · DATA CC BY 4.0
TAKE IT AND GO

CREDIT WHERE IT IS OWED

I did not invent this format.

Downtown Tampa is a domain fork of “The 2026 Iran War: A Geoeconomic Autopsy” — same architecture, same citation standard, a different subject.

THE ORIGINAL

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THE WHOLE POINT OF PUTTING IT IN THE OPEN

Fork it. Do your city.

Tampa is not special here — the structure is. Every city has a clearance decade, a highway that went through somebody, and a waterfront somebody is selling. Swap the data layer and the machine runs on your archive.

- 1 Fork the repo. Keep **index.html** and **js/app.js** as they are.
- 2 Rewrite **js/data.js** with your city's eras, events and series — one source object per figure.
- 3 Run **node tools/validate-data.mjs** and **tools/check-links.mjs**. They fail you honestly.
- 4 Publish on GitHub Pages. Send me the link — I want to read it.

CODE CC0 1.0 · DATA CC BY 4.0 · NO ATTRIBUTION REQUIRED, BUT WELCOME